Repotting Checklist

A calm, step-by-step move-in day for your plant.

GETTING STARTED

Repotting frightens people more than it frightens plants, and it usually goes wrong for small avoidable reasons: a pot that is too big, a day that was already stressful, scissors that were never sharpened. This checklist turns the job into three short stages — before, during, after — so you can put a tick next to each step and relax your way through it.

PRINT IT RIGHT

- US Letter paper, portrait, 100 % scale (“Actual size”, never “Fit to page”).
- Print one sheet per repotting session and tape it somewhere near the mess.
- You will be working with wet hands — the sheet is fine, but keep it out of the soil pile.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- Skip repotting a plant that is already sick or showing new yellowing; stabilize first.
- Spring is move-in season — plants are waking up and recover fastest then.

> **Tip:** New pot only a little larger than the old one — two to five centimeters wider. A pot with room to spare is a swimming pool in miniature: the extra soil holds water the roots cannot yet drink and quietly rots them.

Repotting Checklist

Plant: _____ Date: _____ Old pot size → new: _____

A FEW DAYS BEFORE

- [ ] Water the plant so the rootball is easy to slide out.
- [ ] New pot is **2–5 cm wider** and has a drainage hole.
- [ ] Fresh potting mix on hand, plus a little plain bark or perlite for drainage.
- [ ] Newspaper, a tarp, or a big tray laid down for the mess.
- [ ] Scissors, trowel or spoon, gloves, and a label with the plant's name.

DURING (DO THIS GENTLY, AND STOP IF A ROOT FIGHTS BACK)

- [ ] Tip the pot sideways, squeeze or rap the sides, slide the rootball out — never yank the stem.
- [ ] Loosen the outer roots gently with fingers; snip only dead, spiraling, or mushy roots.
- [ ] Scrub or rinse the old pot if reusing it — no salt crust on the sides.
- [ ] Crumble away the loosest third of old mix only — do not strip the rootball bare.
- [ ] Pot sits at the same depth as before; the crown of the plant is not buried.
- [ ] Add mix down the sides, tap to settle, then water once, well.

THE DAYS AFTER (QUIET OBSERVATION WEEK)

- [ ] Keep out of direct sun and away from cold drafts for about a week.
- [ ] Hold the fertilizer — wait until new leaves appear (this is often 2–4 weeks).
- [ ] Some drooping drama on day one is normal; deep shriveling that worsens is a call-back.
- [ ] Log the date on a Plant Profile Card or the Fertilizer Date Log.

SURE SIGNS IT IS REPOT TIME

- [ ] Roots circling out of the drainage hole or surfacing on top.
- [ ] Water runs through in seconds — the rootball crowds all the soil.
- [ ] The plant dries out within a day of watering.
- [ ] Growth has stalled a full season for no other reason.

NOTES ON THIS SESSION

Root condition, mix used, anything to watch:

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